



LEADING THE LEGACY: A PROGRAM FOR TRANSITION, DIALOGUE, AND THE FUTURE

Submitted for Staff Development and Training (ORLD 5055)
Fall 2025 | Dr. Ghosh

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Training Needs Analysis

Background

A third-generation, family-owned bottling company stands at a critical juncture. The founder, now in his eighties, remains the central decision-maker, while his children—leaders in their forties—are poised to steer the company toward modernization. This has created a palpable tension between honoring a profound legacy and embracing necessary evolution. These strategic challenges are compounded by interpersonal dynamics: difficult conversations are avoided, an untrained HR representative exacerbates tensions, and communication breakdowns between departments hinder daily operations. The company's future depends on navigating this human terrain as much as its strategic direction.

Needs Analysis Procedures/Methods

To ground our understanding in data, we propose a multi-method Training Needs Analysis (TNA) targeting the interconnected strategic and interpersonal problems.

1. Semi-Structured Interviews: One-on-one conversations with the patriarch, his children, the General Manager, and key department heads will provide qualitative depth on succession expectations and communication barriers.
2. Anonymous Employee Survey: A digital survey distributed to a cross-section of employees will quantify perceptions of psychological safety, conflict management, and readiness for change.
3. Document Analysis: A review of organizational charts and meeting minutes will reveal patterns of decision-making paralysis and communication silos.

Summary of Findings & Results

The TNA is designed to confirm that the core challenges are behavioral and relational. We anticipate findings will reveal:

- A stalled leadership transition without a formal plan, creating strategic ambiguity and fueling conflict between legacy and modernization.
- Pervasively low emotional intelligence (EQ), manifesting as an inability to manage emotions during disagreement and a systematic avoidance of difficult conversations.

Synthesized Conclusion: The company's strategic impasse is sustained by its interpersonal dynamics. The high-stakes context of succession triggers conflict, while the lack of EQ ensures that conflict is mismanaged, creating a cycle that blocks progress.

Justification for Training as the Solution

A targeted training program is the most direct intervention to break this cycle. While structural changes are needed, they will fail without a shift in underlying behaviors. Training is uniquely suited to:

1. **Build Foundational Skills:** It directly addresses the root cause by developing the specific EQ and communication capabilities that are currently lacking.
2. **Create a Practice Environment:** It provides a psychologically safe container for family leaders to practice the difficult conversations about succession they currently avoid.
3. **Enable Strategic Execution:** It is the essential catalyst that equips the leadership team with the relational tools required to collaboratively design and implement their future.

Training Design

Analysis of Potential Learners and Work Setting

The success of this program hinges on its relevance to the learners and their context. The primary audience includes the founder, the successor generation, the General Manager, and key department heads. They operate in a unique, relationship-driven culture where informal processes and personal loyalties often supersede formal structure, making the introduction of new communication norms both challenging and essential.

Potential Learners

No.	Learner Group	Rationale	Learning Focus
1	Family Patriarch (Founder)	The founder is still in charge and central to decision-making, but may resist change, having led the company for decades.	• How to honor the company's past, embrace change, and clearly communicate their role transition. • Understanding why new formal systems are essential for future growth.
2	Succession Generation (Children)	The children of the founder (in their 40s) are eager to modernize the company but are	How to manage their emotions (EQ), navigate generational conflict, and make decisions that balance tradition with modernization.

		caught in tension with the founder's leadership style.	
3	General Manager (GM)	Acts as a bridge between family members and departments, handling conflicts that arise from leadership tension.	• How to mediate conflicts and ensure clear communication between the family members and operational teams. • How to use their position to enforce authority professionally without exacerbating the family dynamics.
4	Department Heads (Sales, Warehouse, Drivers)	These leaders manage day-to-day operations but face breakdowns in communication across departments.	• Active listening, providing constructive feedback, and understanding how the leadership transition will affect their roles. • How to engage with leaders across the company more effectively, bridging departmental gaps.

Work Setting

The company operates in a highly relational culture (Family-Owned Business), with many long-term employees who are used to informal processes.

Issues:

- No formalized decision-making structure, heavily reliant on personal relationships (HR rep due to a 20-year friendship with the founder).
- Tension between legacy (the founder's way of doing things) and modernization (the next generation's ideas).
- Communication breakdowns between departments, causing delays and inefficiencies.

Description of the Goals and Objectives of the Training

The program's goal is to equip the leadership team with the emotional intelligence and communication skills necessary to navigate their transition, honor the company's legacy, and build a modernized future.

Upon completion, participants will be able to:

- Articulate the company's core legacy and identify areas for modernization.
- Apply emotional intelligence techniques to de-escalate conflict and manage difficult conversations.
- Utilize a structured dialogue framework to facilitate productive succession discussions.
- Co-create and commit to a 90-day action plan to launch the leadership transition.

Training Task and Content Analysis

The program is a progressive journey from awareness to action across four modules:

- **Module 1: The Foundation** builds self-awareness and a shared understanding of the company's legacy.
- **Module 2: The Engine** develops core EQ skills for emotional self-regulation.
- **Module 3: The Bridge** applies these skills to structured practice of succession conversations.
- **Module 4: The Blueprint** translates dialogue into a co-created, actionable transition plan.

Training Participant Manual

Executive Summary

This program, *Leading the Legacy*, is designed for the family and key leaders of a multigenerational bottling company. It is a developmental journey that moves from building self-awareness and emotional intelligence to practicing structured dialogue, culminating in a collaborative plan for the company's future. Through reflection, role-play, and facilitated discussion, participants will gain the confidence and skills to navigate the human side of their leadership transition.

Program Objectives

(Objectives are listed above in the Training Design section and are not repeated here to avoid redundancy.)

Detailed Lesson Plans

This program is structured as a progressive journey across four modules. Each module builds upon the last, moving from foundational awareness to concrete planning. The detailed, 60-minute lesson plan for each session can be found in the [Detailed Lesson Plan Section](#) of this manual.

- **Module 1: The Foundation: Understanding Ourselves & the Landscape**
 - **Session Title: Mapping Our Legacy: Appreciating the Past to Inform the Future**
- **Module 2: The Engine: Emotional Intelligence for Difficult Conversations**
 - **Session Title: From Reaction to Response: Managing Triggers in High-Stakes Talks**
- **Module 3: The Bridge: Facilitating Constructive Dialogue**
 - **Session Title: The Transition Talk: A Structured Framework for Succession Conversations**
- **Module 4: The Blueprint: Co-Creating the Path Forward**
 - **Session Title: From Vision to Action: Drafting Our First 90-Day Transition Plan**

Inventories, Assessments & Reflections

These tools are designed for personal and collaborative reflection. They will help you internalize key concepts, assess your current habits, and plan for real-world application. We recommend completing each activity during its designated session to get the most out of the learning experience.

- **Legacy Interview Worksheet (Appendix 3):** A guided conversation framework to uncover the core values and pivotal stories that built the company, helping to distinguish enduring strengths from practices that may need evolution.
- **Difficult Conversation Reflection Handout (Appendix 5):** A self-assessment tool to increase your awareness of personal emotional triggers and default behaviors during conflict, building a foundation for more mindful responses.
- **Transition Talk Planner (Appendix 9):** A structured template to prepare for and navigate high-stakes succession conversations, ensuring you enter them with clarity, purpose, and a constructive framework.

Job Aids and Handouts

These quick-reference materials are your go-to resources for use during the training and, most importantly, back on the job. They are designed to provide immediate guidance and reinforce the skills learned throughout the program.

- **S.T.A.R. Framework Visual (Appendix 7):** A one-page, step-by-step visual guide to the S.T.A.R. (Setting, Tone, Approach, Resolution) model, providing a reliable structure for facilitating productive and respectful dialogue.
- **Legacy Map (Appendix 4):** A visual snapshot of the company's core identity, co-created by the group, which serves as a tangible reminder of the shared values to protect and the collective priorities for modernizing the business.
- **90-Day Priority Planner (Appendix 10):** A practical worksheet to translate strategic vision into actionable priorities, helping the leadership team define clear owners and milestones for the initial phase of the transition.
- **My First Step Commitment Card (Appendix 11):** A simple yet powerful tool to solidify your personal commitment by defining one specific, immediate action you will take to advance the transition plan, fostering individual accountability.

Participant Feedback Survey

At the conclusion of the program, please complete the short survey below to help us improve future sessions.

Scale: 1 = Strongly Disagree 5 = Strongly Agree

Statement	1	2	3	4	5
The content was relevant to my role and our company's challenges.					
The facilitators were engaging and clear.					
The activities helped me understand and apply new skills.					
I feel more confident handling difficult conversations after this training.					
I plan to apply what I learned in the next 30 days.					

Open-Ended Questions

1. What part of the training was most valuable to you?
2. What would you change or add for next time?

3. One action I will take immediately after the program is: _____

Training Program Evaluation

Training Evaluation Plan

To systematically measure the effectiveness of the "Leading the Legacy" program, we will employ the Kirkpatrick Model, a four-level framework for evaluating training. This comprehensive plan assesses the program from immediate reactions to long-term business impact.

Level 1: Reaction

We will measure participants' immediate reactions to gauge initial satisfaction and engagement.

- **Evaluation Method:** Post-Training Feedback Survey
- **Description:** Measures participants' immediate satisfaction with the training, relevance of content, and facilitator effectiveness
- **Timing & Frequency:** Immediately after each of the 4 modules (4 times total)
- **Tool:** Exhibit A: Sample Feedback Survey with Likert-scale questions and open-ended sections

Level 2: Learning

We will assess knowledge and skill acquisition through multiple demonstration methods.

- **Evaluation Method:** Skill Demonstration & Knowledge Checks
- **Description:**
 - Modules 1 & 2: "Personal Insight Worksheet" documenting key takeaways about legacy and emotional triggers
 - Module 3: Facilitator-observed role-play using rubric to score S.T.A.R. model application
 - Module 4: Completed "90-Day Transition Plan" as synthesis of learning
- **Timing & Frequency:** At the end of Modules 1, 2, and 3; output of Module 4 (continuous throughout program)
- **Tool:** Exhibit B: Role-Play Observation Rubric

Level 3: Behavior

We will evaluate workplace application through multi-source feedback.

- **Evaluation Method:** 60-Day Post-Training Follow-Up Survey & Interviews

- **Description:**
 - Survey to participants and direct reports for 360-degree feedback on communication and conflict management changes
 - 30-minute interviews with family members and GM about skill application in real succession conversations
- **Timing & Frequency:** 60 days after final module (once)
- **Tool:** Exhibit C: 60-Day Follow-Up Survey focusing on behavioral indicators

Level 4: Results

We will measure business impact through key organizational metrics.

- **Evaluation Method:** Review of Business Metrics & 90-Day Plan Progress
- **Description:**
 - Primary Metric: Successful implementation of 90-Day Transition Plan (milestones met, roles clarified)
 - Secondary Metrics: Reduction in departmental conflicts, improved employee sentiment scores, formal succession plan adoption
- **Timing & Frequency:** 90 days after final module (once, with potential 1-year follow-up)
- **Tool:** Exhibit D: 90-Day Plan Progress Report Template

Transfer of Learning Checkpoints

Ensuring learning is applied on the job requires intentional support before, during, and after the training. Our transfer plan is designed to embed the new skills into the company's culture and daily routines.

Before Training (Preparing for Transfer):

- **Managerial Buy-In Session:** The General Manager and Patriarch will meet with the facilitators to align on the program's goals and their critical role as champions of the new skills.
- **Pre-Work Assignment:** Participants will complete a "Pre-Training Reflection" identifying one specific, real-life difficult conversation or succession-related challenge they are facing. This primes them to connect the training directly to their work.

During Training (Enabling Transfer):

- **Action-Oriented Activities:** Every module is built around real-world application:
 - **Module 1** creates a tangible "Legacy Map."

- **Module 2** uses personalized trigger checklists.
- **Module 3** practices with real-life role-play scenarios from the company.
- **Module 4** produces the concrete "90-Day Transition Plan."
- **Peer Coaching:** Participants will be placed in accountability trios to provide feedback during exercises and commit to supporting each other after the training.

After Training (Sustaining Transfer):

- **Accountability Trios Check-Ins:** The trios will hold brief, monthly virtual check-ins for the first 90 days to discuss progress, challenges, and successes in using the new skills.
- **GM as a Reinforcement Coach:** The General Manager will be provided with a "Reinforcement Guide" with discussion prompts to use in monthly one-on-one meetings with the family leaders, focusing on their progress with the 90-Day Plan and their use of EQ skills.
- **Job Aids & Visual Reminders:** Participants will receive laminated job aids of the S.T.A.R. model and the "From Reaction to Response" technique to keep at their desks. The finalized "Legacy Map" and "90-Day Transition Plan" will be printed and displayed in a common area.

Appendices (Exhibits) for Evaluation

Note: All supporting documents, including detailed lesson plans, worksheets, job aids, and evaluation tools, are compiled in a separate [Supplementary Materials](#) document for reference.

Appendices: Lesson Materials

Needs Analysis Tools

- [Appendix 1: Sample Interview Questions](#)
- [Appendix 2: Sample Survey Excerpts](#)

Session 1: Mapping Our Legacy

- [Appendix 3: Legacy Interview Worksheet](#)
- [Appendix 4: The Legacy Map](#)

Session 2: From Reaction to Response

- [Appendix 5: Difficult Conversation Reflection Handout](#)
- [Appendix 6: Workplace Difficult Conversation Scenarios](#)

Session 3: The Transition Talk

- [Appendix 7: S.T.A.R. Framework Visual](#)
- [Appendix 8: Succession Scenario Cards](#)
- [Appendix 9: Transition Talk Planner Worksheet](#)

Session 4: From Vision to Action

- [Appendix 10: 90-Day Priority Planner Worksheet](#)
- [Appendix 11: My First Step Commitment Card](#)

Detailed Lesson Plans

- [Session 1: 60-Minute Lesson Plan](#)
- [Session 2: 60-Minute Lesson Plan](#)
- [Session 3: 60-Minute Lesson Plan](#)
- [Session 4: 60-Minute Lesson Plan](#)

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